

CONCEPT DEVELOPMENT DECK

BERG

**A first-person co-op climbing
adventure set on the
Zugspitze.**

Players climb together on a shared mountain server, where route choice, weather, oxygen, cold, stamina and rope safety define the outcome of each expedition.

PC

PLATFORM

12+

AUDIENCE

FFF Bayern

HIGH CONCEPT 2.0

ELEVATOR PITCH

A grounded co-op climbing adventure set on the Zugspitze.

BERG is a first-person co-op game about reaching the summit in modern alpine conditions. Players start at the base of the mountain, choose routes, deliver supplies, complete tasks and climb upward while overcoming environmental obstacles.

The core interaction is simple and readable: control each hand, manage grip, secure the rope, monitor oxygen and keep moving. Depth comes from route choice, weather pressure, oxygen management, cold exposure and the presence of other players on the same mountain.

Key points

- Zugspitze setting
- Friends-first co-op
- Readable alpine pressure

USK 6/12
TARGET
RATING

60+ min
SESSION
TARGET

Grounded
MOOD TARGET

MOMENT-TO-MOMENT LOOP

The climb is built around clear physical decisions.

BERG translates climbing into a readable gameplay loop. Players read the route, climb by moving each hand separately, attach themselves to rope anchors and monitor their body state under changing alpine conditions.

01

Read the route

Players follow marked climbing lines, evaluate the next section and choose when to continue, rest or change approach.

02

Move each hand

Separate left and right hand inputs create the core climbing rhythm.

03

Attach to anchors

Players secure themselves to fixed rope points to reduce fall risk and create safer progress.

04

Monitor body state

Cold, oxygen and stamina affect movement speed, grip reliability and recovery.

Failure model

Fall, ragdoll, freeze, recover. Mistakes do not delete the run. Players can lose time, position and route progress, but return to a recoverable state or respawn from the checkpoint.

Weather pressure

Changing weather supports longer 60+ minute attempts. Strong wind can interfere with movement and drown out voice chat. Snowstorms reduce visibility and can separate players, creating tense moments where teammates must call out to find each other again.

MOUNTAIN STRUCTURE

One mountain, multiple routes to the same summit.

All players start at the base of the mountain. The mountain contains several rope-marked routes that all lead toward the same summit, but each route creates a different risk profile. At the beginning, only one route is clearly available. As players progress, they unlock new routes and learn which lines are safer, faster or more demanding under specific conditions.

NPC tasks give players practical goals during the climb. Completing tasks rewards currency that can be spent on better oxygen tanks, improved hand stamina, longer ropes, winch-based rope tools, radios and other climbing gadgets.

There is one main checkpoint in the middle of the mountain. It reduces frustration while preserving the feeling of one continuous climb.

Route logic

Base -> route choice -> middle checkpoint -> summit push

Quest examples

- Deliver an oxygen tank to an intermediate camp
- Deliver supplies to a high-altitude tent camp
- Bring down an NPC suffering from altitude sickness
- Evacuate climbers stranded on the route

SIMULATION PILLARS

Realism is expressed through readable gameplay systems.

BERG should feel grounded and atmospheric without becoming a hardcore climbing simulator. The player has a clear HUD for important survival and movement indicators, while the mountain systems directly affect moment-to-moment decisions.

SYSTEM	PLAYER-FACING INFORMATION	GAMEPLAY EFFECT
Wind speed / direction	Wind strength, direction and exposed route sections	Pushes players sideways, makes some sections harder and can increase fall risk
Cold and snow	Temperature drop, snowstorm intensity and exposure	Slows movement, increases pressure to rest or reach shelter
Snowstorm visibility	Reduced visibility in bad weather	Players can lose sight of teammates and must communicate to regroup
Voice distance	Proximity voice affected by distance and weather	Strong wind and snowstorms make communication harder
Oxygen	Tank amount and thin-air pressure	Lower oxygen makes stamina drain faster during vertical climbs
Hand stamina	Separate grip stamina for climbing actions	Forces pauses, safer route choices and better timing

SOCIAL MOUNTAIN

Multiplayer turns the mountain into a shared expedition space.

BERG is not limited to a closed four-player party. The concept is built around a cloud-hosted Photon server where multiple teams share the same mountain, cross paths on routes, hear nearby players through distance-based voice chat and create organic rescue, supply and cooperation moments.

Public base

Players gather, choose routes, accept tasks and form groups.

Route traffic

Teams cross each other on easier and more technical climbing lines.

Emergent help

Supplies, rescue actions and rope support become social interactions.

Summit stories / leaderboard

The server records who reached the summit and under which conditions.

Up to 100

ONLINE PLAYERS

Unity + Photon

TECHNICAL DIRECTION

Distance voice + global text

COMMUNICATION

PROGRESSION AND RETENTION

Replayability comes from upgrades, harder routes and shared stories.

BERG is designed around repeated attempts to reach the summit under different conditions. Players improve their equipment, unlock more demanding routes and return to the mountain with different friends to experience new failures, rescues and summit stories.

Progression

- Better oxygen tanks
- Improved hand stamina
- Longer ropes
- Radios and climbing gadgets
- New route access

Retention

- Try a harder route
- Return with another group
- Recover from failed attempts
- Create memorable co-op moments
- Reach the summit under different conditions

Business model

Premium Steam

Buy once, invite friends, climb the mountain.

MARKET POSITION

Climbing games show clear demand, but PC still has room for a grounded social alpine title.

BERG is positioned between PEAK and more realistic Roblox climbing experiences such as K2 Climbing Simulator. The goal is a dedicated premium PC product, not a mod or platform-limited experience.

PEAK

A strong reference for social climbing with broad streamer-friendly readability. Its tone is closer to fantasy, friendslop and comedy than to an atmospheric climbing simulation.

BERG

A dedicated premium PC climbing adventure set in the Bavarian Alps. BERG focuses on grounded atmosphere, route planning, weather pressure, proximity voice and shared-server expeditions.

Roblox K2 Climbing Simulator

A proof that players respond to climb-to-summit progression and public mountain status. Roblox shows the demand, while BERG translates the appeal into a dedicated PC Steam product.

BERG difference

BERG combines PEAK's social readability with K2's climb-to-summit progression, then moves both toward a grounded PC Steam experience: Zugspitze setting, weather pressure, proximity voice and shared-server expeditions.

FFF BAYERN CONCEPT PHASE

The goal is to make BERG ready for further production funding.

The High Concept 2.0 phase is focused on clarifying the design, market positioning, technical scope and visual direction before moving into production.

High Concept 2.0

A polished English concept deck and written design thesis for FFF follow-up evaluation.

Additional concept-phase deliverables

- GDD 1.0
- Financial plan
- Cost plan for a future prototype funding application

Bavarian relevance

The Zugspitze and the German Alps give the project a clear local cultural and geographic anchor.

Generative AI disclosure

AI may be used as an ideation aid during concept work. Final application material should clearly label the role of AI and remain under human creative direction.

TEAM AND ASK

ZweiBier Indie can turn a focused concept grant into a fundable production package.

Applicants: Aleksandr Varko - ZweiBier Indie, Munich. The production team is intentionally small and focused: Aleksandr Varko leads programming, multiplayer systems and producing. PMB Interactive contributes art direction, visual concepts and level design — backed by 20+ years of game development experience, 50+ published titles and awards including the Apple Design Award and the Deutscher Computerspielpreis.

Aleksandr Varko

Programming, multiplayer systems and producing

Matthias Baudrexl

FOUNDER PMB INTERACTIVE UG

PMB Interactive contributes art direction, visual concepts and level design

REQUEST

20 000 euro

Dreadway

SHIPPED COMMERCIAL STEAM REFERENCE

Munich

HOME-BASED BAVARIAN DEVELOPMENT

PC Steam

PREMIUM MULTIPLAYER RELEASE PATH

High Concept 2.0

DESIGN, MARKET, TECHNICAL SCOPE AND ART PACKAGE